

Project Plan

ClassMate

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Document Revision History

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2.7	2025-10-23

TEAM CHARTER

Multiple reasons exist for preparing a team charter. One is to document the team's purpose and clearly define individual roles, responsibilities, and operating rules. Next, it establishes procedures for both the team and management/industry partner on communicating, reporting, and decision-making procedures. It lays out a blueprint for conducting business for the acquisition and defines how the team works in an empowered manner, including setting out responsibility and authority. Finally it facilitates stakeholder buy in by including key members in the decision making process and obtaining their concurrence along the way.

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1. Purpose

(Describe the purpose for forming the team and the anticipated outcomes.)

ClassMate is founded on the belief that every student deserves the right tools to succeed. Much like an ideal classmate who reminds you of important deadlines, motivates you to stay on track, and helps keep everything organized, ClassMate aims to make academic life simpler and more manageable. Our team was formed to design and develop a student-centered organizational platform that consolidates deadlines, assignments, and performance tracking into one accessible space.

Building on this vision, the project focuses on creating a centralized platform that helps students manage their academic responsibilities with ease. The application will bring together assignment tracking, deadline reminders, grade projections, and course load management in one intuitive hub. By simplifying how students organize their academic life, it aims to reduce stress, increase productivity, and support better decision-making. The anticipated outcome is a reliable and student-focused solution that empowers learners to stay organized, motivated, and confident throughout their academic journey.

2. Background

(Summarize the program or project the team is supporting, state how the team fits within the organizational structure, identify who are the users/customers of the program/project including external customers and stakeholders, and ~~describe special circumstances surrounding the project.~~)

ClassMate is a student life management platform designed to help learners stay organized, manage deadlines, and gain clearer visibility into their academic progress. The project addresses the growing need for centralized academic planning tools in post-secondary education, where students are often balancing multiple courses, work, and personal commitments. Students frequently struggle to track deadlines, resulting in late or missed submissions, and often lack a clear sense of whether they are on track to meet their academic goals. This creates unnecessary stress, poor time management, and limited opportunities for early intervention. At this stage, the primary focus is on empowering students to manually enter and manage their own academic information, creating a personal hub for assignments, deadlines, and performance tracking.

The ClassMate team operates as a development unit within a college academic project framework, under the guidance of the course instructor and capstone advisor. Future iterations of the platform envision optional integration with learning management systems such as Brightspace, enabling more seamless access to course deadlines and grade information directly from institutional systems. With over 15 million learners worldwide using Brightspace, the market clearly reflects a strong demand for digital academic support tools. While the current version focuses on student-led organization and planning, future enhancements will allow advisors and instructors to contribute and update academic data, improving visibility and coordination without compromising student control. By bridging this gap, ClassMate aims to offer students a more cohesive, flexible, and proactive approach to managing their academic journey.

D2L. (n.d.). *Brightspace: Learning management system (LMS)*. D2L. Retrieved October 23, 2025, from <https://www.d2l.com/>

3. Scope

(State the scope, mission, and objectives for the project and the team's role in achieving it. This is similar to preparing a mission need statement. Define the high level goals the team must accomplish.)

The mission of the ClassMate project is to provide students with a centralized academic management tool that simplifies organization, enhances visibility into academic progress, and reduces stress associated with managing multiple courses. The need for this project stems from the growing challenges students face in tracking deadlines, managing workload, and understanding their academic performance. By consolidating essential academic information into one accessible platform, ClassMate aims to help students plan more effectively and save valuable time.

The scope of this project includes four major deliverables. First, a mark monitoring system that allows students to input grades and view both course-specific and overall performance, including automatic projections of their academic trajectory. Second, a task tracking feature that enables students to add assignments and milestones with deadlines, supported by a completion tracker to provide quantifiable progress. Third, a notification system that delivers default and user-created reminders for upcoming due dates, study sessions, and assignment checkpoints. Finally, comprehensive user documentation will be developed and embedded directly into the application, with a downloadable copy available to support ease of adoption.

By the end of the initial sprint, 100% of high-level requirements and user stories have been documented, laying the foundation for the functional prototype. The expected impact of these features is a 15% reduction in time spent on manual academic organization tasks, enabling students to focus more on actual learning and performance. The ClassMate team's role is to design, develop, and deliver the core functionality of the application, ensuring it is intuitive, accessible, and student-centered.

4. Team composition

(Identify the functional areas represented, the number of members from each, state who are core [essential] members versus support or advisory members and full or part time designation, and the anticipated time/resources commitments involved over the anticipated duration of the team.)

The ClassMate project team is made up of a small, focused group of core members supported by advisory roles. The core team consists of four members, responsible for planning, designing, and developing the application. Functional areas represented include software development (responsible for building and testing features), user experience and interface design (ensuring ease of use), and business analysis (defining requirements and aligning the project with student needs). These members are designated as full-time contributors for the duration of the project and are directly involved in sprint execution and deliverable completion.

Support and advisory roles include the course instructor and capstone project lead, who provide oversight, approve project plans, and review key milestones. Their involvement is part-time and focused on guidance rather than daily operations. Communication with stakeholders and documentation distribution are managed collaboratively by the team, ensuring transparency and accountability throughout the project timeline.

5. Team empowerment Purpose

(Define existing authority the team, by virtue of its individual membership, already possesses, additional authority needed to fully perform as envisioned by the team objectives, and level of empowerment requested.).

The ClassMate team is composed of four core members who bring together both technical and business expertise. Functional areas represented include software development, user experience design, and business analysis. Each team member contributes full-time throughout the project, taking responsibility for planning, building, testing, and refining the application. This structure ensures that both the technical foundation and the user experience are developed in parallel, resulting in a cohesive and well-aligned product. The team also shares responsibilities for documentation, communication, and distribution of deliverables, ensuring transparency and consistency across all stages of the project.

6. Team operations

(Describe team operational plans. This includes, for example, such activities as the team's decision-making processes, how changes in membership occur should the need arise, plans to establish "ground" or operating rules, handling absence or non-performance, code repository, communication amongst team members, relationships with other organizational entities or teams, logistical support, etc.).

The ClassMate team operates through a collaborative and transparent decision-making process. All key decisions are made during scheduled team meetings, and outcomes are documented in meeting minutes to ensure accountability and alignment. The team follows a majority-rule approach, allowing decisions to be made democratically while ensuring every member's voice is heard. If membership changes become necessary, approval by project advisor is required and will be based on peer-evaluation submissions. All project code must be stored in a shared code repository, project documents are stored on a shared google drive and communication takes place through agreed-upon online channels to keep everyone connected and informed.

Operating rules have been established to support smooth collaboration. The team meets exclusively online at predetermined times, which are set and confirmed in advance. Team messages must be acknowledged within 48 hours (weekends and holidays excluded), and members are expected to actively participate in discussions and assigned tasks. Any proposed use of new technologies or programming languages must be approved by the full team to ensure shared understanding and feasibility. These guidelines provide a clear framework for how the team collaborates, communicates, and stays on track throughout the project lifecycle.

7. Team Performance Assessment

(Document key areas of performance needed for team success along with means of measuring progress.)

Sprint 3:

The team will complete wireframes and mockups for all core features, conduct at least one UI review, and finalize the design framework and style guide. By the end of the sprint, at least 80% of the static front-end structure will be in place to support upcoming development.

Sprint 5:

Coding will begin with the implementation of mark monitoring, task tracking, and notification features. The task tracker will reach at least 70% functionality, while notifications will support both default and custom reminders. Unit testing will be introduced with a target of 60% code coverage.

Sprint 6:

The team will integrate all modules into a working MVP and raise testing coverage to 80%. User documentation will be finalized and distributed, and an estimated 15% time savings will be demonstrated through feature testing.

Sprint 7:

Focus on refinement and delivery. All critical bugs and most minor issues will be resolved, the UI will be polished for accessibility and usability, and a complete end-to-end MVP demonstration will be presented with supporting documentation.

8. Signature Page

(Each team member signs, agreeing to the contents and being held mutually accountable for adherence.)

Name	Signature	Date
Penny Ahlstrom		2025-10-24
James Jones		2025-10-24
Omar McIntosh		2025-10-26
Nezihe Tekin		2025-10-26